

INTONATION RULES (↗, ↘)

As a general rule, intonation is used to add colour and emotion to our speech. There are basically three types of intonation: the falling tone, the rising tone and the falling-rising tone.

The Falling tone (is used for)

1. Ordinary statements, eg. I haven't seen him for over a ↘year.
2. Commands, eg. Pick up that piece of paper at ↘once.
3. Exclamations, eg. What a pleasant sur↘prise?
4. Wh- questions asked in a neutral way, eg. What is your ↘name?
5. Question tags when the speaker wants the listener to agree, eg. She's a clever girl, ↘isn't she?
6. Yes/No questions asked in an indifferent or cold manner, eg. Do you know the ↘answer?

The Rising tone (is used for)

1. Statements expressing surprise, disbelief or sarcasm, eg. That man is Reena's ↗father(?)
2. Yes/No questions asked in a normal or friendly way, eg. Is she the daughter of your ↗friend?
3. Intonation questions, i.e., sentences which have the structure of statements but turn into questions because of rising intonation, eg. You'll leave next ↗week(?)
4. Requests, eg. Can you get me a glass of ↗water? (when falling tone is used, they become command.)
5. Suggestions, eg. Shall we take a bus to the ↗stations?
6. Question tags seeking information, eg. The last train leaves at nine, ↗doesn't it?
7. Wh- questions asked in a friendly way, eg. What is your ↗name?
8. Wh- questions indicating a feeling of surprise, eg. How did he dare to a↗buse you?
9. Wh- question when the speaker is asking for the repetition of what was said earlier, eg. When was the last time you ↗met him?

The Falling - Rising tone (is used for)

1. Polite requests, eg. Could I borrow your phone?
2. To express disbelief on the speaker's part, eg. You have won the gold medal for debating?
3. In short questions to show enthusiasm, eg. Did you?
4. When making a polite correction to something someone had said, eg. You have completed the report on Thursday? , No, not Thursday., Tuesday.
5. In incomplete utterances, eg. Well.....
